

FSDI – 115 ASSIGNMENT SUBMISSION REPORT

 STUDENT:	Tim Strubell
 COURSE:	FSDI 115 – User Experience and Responsive Design
 COHORT #:	Cohort 68
 CLASS #:	Class 1
 ASSIGNMENT #:	Assignment 1 – <u>UX COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS & USER RESEARCH</u> <u>STRUBELL GOODS & GEAR (SGNG)</u>
 SUBMISSION DATE:	September 14, 2026
 FOLDER NAME:	fsdi115_ch68_cl1_asgmt1_strubell
 GITHUB REPO LINK:	https://github.com/TStrubell/FSDI_115_UXRD.git

ASSIGNMENT 1: UX COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS & USER RESEARCH

SECTION 1 – PROJECT INFORMATION:

PROJECT NAME: *Strubell Goods & Gear (SGnG)*

TEAM MEMBER(S): *Tim Strubell*

SELECTED PROJECT: *A responsive e-commerce platform experience for **premium handmade leather** goods, including wallets, belts, keychains, and travel bags.*

DATE: *September 2026*

1.1 – PROJECT OVERVIEW

Strubell Goods & Gear (SGnG) is a **Premium Handmade Leather Goods** brand offering wallets, belts, keychains, and travel bags. The goal of this project is to design a modern, responsive e-commerce experience that highlights craftsmanship, product quality, and usability while delivering a seamless shopping experience across desktop and mobile devices

SECTION 2 – COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS:

2.1 – WEBSITE #1: **BELLROY**

WEBSITE #1: Bellroy



WEBSITE URL: <https://bellroy.com>

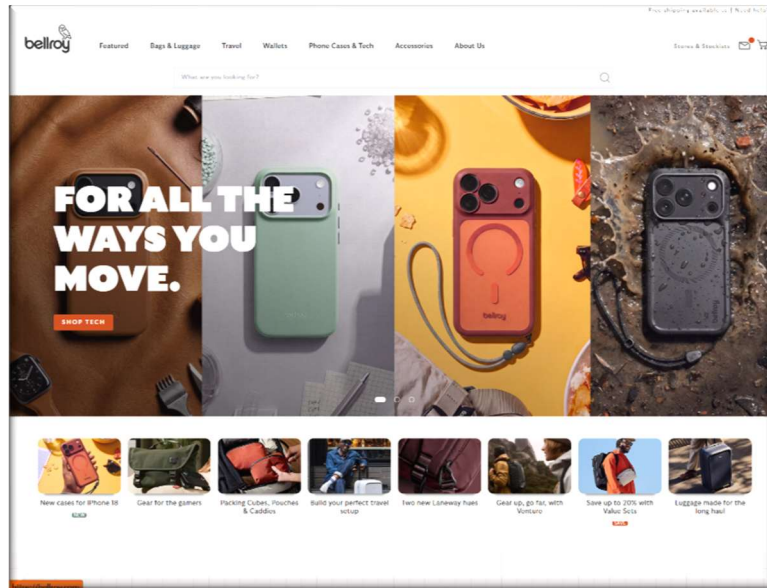


FIGURE 1. Bellroy desktop homepage showing prominent navigation, search, visual storytelling, and category-based product discovery.

A. ✓ What does this website do well?:

- Clean navigation
- High-quality product photography
- Minimalist design
- Easy product discovery
- Strong mobile experience

B. ⚠ Usability Issues:

- Some product information requires additional scrolling.
- Storytelling sections may be lengthy for users seeking quick purchases.

C. 💡 Ideas for SGnG:

- Sticky navigation bar.
- Larger product images.
- Clean product card layouts.
- Simplified checkout process.

2.2 – WEBSITE #2: SADDLEBACK LEATHER

WEBSITE #2: Saddleback Leather



WEBSITE URL: <https://saddlebackleather.com>

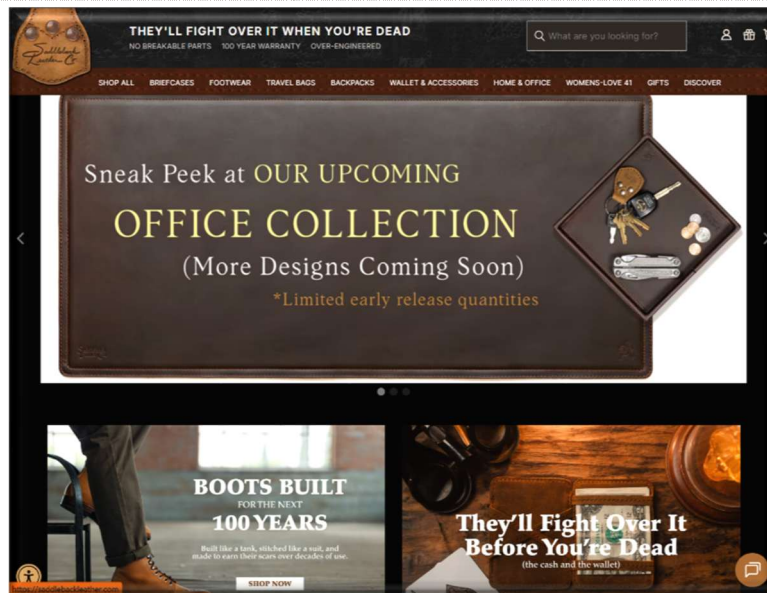


FIGURE 2. Saddleback Leather desktop homepage emphasizing durability, craftsmanship, product categories, and long-term warranty messaging.

A. ✓ What does this website do well?:

- Emphasizes product durability.
- Strong craftsmanship storytelling.
- Detailed product descriptions.
- Builds customer trust.

B. ⚠ Usability Issues:

- Information-heavy pages can feel overwhelming.
- Navigation hierarchy could be simplified.

C. 💡 Ideas for SGN:

- Showcase craftsmanship through visual storytelling.
- Add trust-building content.
- Highlight material quality and product longevity.

2.3 – WEBSITE #3: HUCKBERRY

WEBSITE #3: Huckberry

Huckberry WEBSITE URL: <https://huckberry.com>

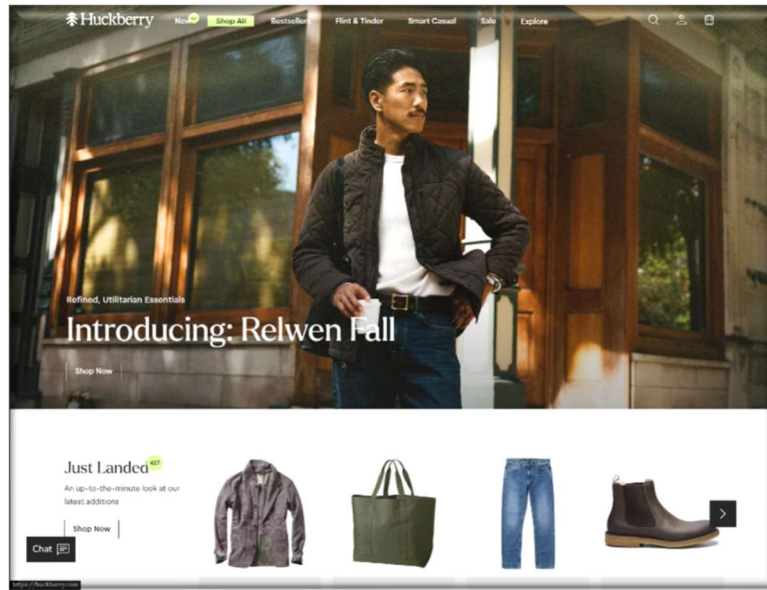


Figure 5. Huckberry desktop homepage combining lifestyle imagery, category navigation, and product discovery.

A. What does this website do well?:

- Modern visual design.
- Excellent product categorization.
- Effective product recommendations.
- Consistent branding.

B. Usability Issues:

- Large product catalog may create decision fatigue.
- Some promotional sections compete for attention.

C. Ideas for SGN:

- Curated product collections.
- Enhanced product filtering.
- Responsive catalog grid layout.

2.4 – HOLISTIC COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS CHART

FEATURE	APP 1: Bellroy	APP 2: Saddleback Leather	APP 3: Huckberry
Easy Navigation	✓	✓	✓
Attractive Interface	✓	✓	✓
Mobile Friendly	✓	⚠	✓
Easy Checkout	✓	✓	✓
Clear Information	✓	✓	✓
Fast Experience	✓	⚠	✓

NOTES:

- **Bellroy** excels in clean design, product organization, and mobile responsiveness.
- **Saddleback Leather** provides excellent product information and storytelling but contains more content-heavy pages.
- **Huckberry** offers strong product discovery, recommendations, and modern visual design.

SECTION 3 – REFLECTION:

A. 🧑 Which application provides the best UX?:

- **Best UX: Bellroy** — Clean layout, strong storytelling, excellent mobile experience.
- **Why Bellroy:** Their product pages balance visuals, details, and usability perfectly.
- **BLUF:** *Bellroy provides the strongest overall user experience due to its clean interface, intuitive navigation, and excellent mobile responsiveness.*

B. 🧩 What common UX patterns were observed?:

- Large product images
- Clear pricing information
- Minimalist navigation
- Consistent branding
- Mobile-first design
- Streamlined shopping experiences
- Visible pricing information

C. 🚀 What improvements will make the biggest difference in SGnG?:

SGnG will improve upon existing competitors by:

- Add a sticky navigation bar.
- Improve product card spacing.
- Create cleaner product detail pages.
- Simplify the checkout process.
- Add a cart notification badge.

D. ★ **Top THREE Features for SGnG:**

1. 📱 Responsive Catalog Grid.
2. 📄 Clean Product Detail Pages.
3. 🖼️ High-Quality Product Images

Additional Features Under Consideration:

- 🕒 Easy Navigation
- 🛒 Simple Shopping Cart | Checkout Experience (*localStorage*).

E. 🚀 **KEY Takeaways:**

- **The most important UX lesson learned is:**
 - Users should be able to find what they need quickly and complete tasks with minimal effort.
- **The biggest mistake to avoid is:**
 - Overcomplicating navigation and overwhelming users with excessive content or too many choices.
- **The feature that provided the most inspiration:**
 - **Bellroy's** clean product pages and mobile-first design approach.

🤖 SECTION 4 – AI DISCLOSURE:

☐ I did not use AI

☒ ***I used AI for help***

☐ AI generated parts of my code

I used **Microsoft Copilot** as a research and writing support tool to help organize information, summarize competitor research, and improve the clarity of this assignment. AI assistance was used for portions of the competitive analysis and reflection sections. I reviewed, edited, fact-checked, and customized all content for **Strubell Goods & Gear (SGnG)** before submission.

This use of AI complies with **SDGKU's** academic guidelines for responsible AI-assisted learning. **Microsoft Copilot was not used to generate source code for this assignment.** All programming and technical work were completed independently by me, Tim Strubell.